

Problem Statement – The Somali Boys

Smallholder farmers in South Africa face a severe information disadvantage within regional agricultural markets. While large commercial enterprises and market speculators leverage real-time data analysis to optimize pricing, crop distribution, and risk management, smallholders operate with minimal market visibility. Relying heavily on intermediaries without transparent pricing data or digital tools, small farms frequently sell crops below fair market value, miss higher-margin trade opportunities, and fall further behind their larger competitors.

Bridging this divide independently is rarely feasible, as smallholders lack the specialized technical skills and formal data training required to build or configure their own digital solutions. Without accessible software engineered specifically for their technical background, small farm enterprises remain trapped in outdated, paper-based, or verbal information systems.

Ultimately, this reliance on informal, incomplete data leads to significant foregone revenue for small-scale producers, entrenching financial vulnerability and structural inequality across South Africa's agricultural sector. An intuitive price-forecasting tool would give small farm businesses the market guidance they need to time their sales and grow their bottom line.